

THE LONG WAY DOWN

Written by

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Production Draft – Blue Revision

INT. NOEL'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

A one-room walk-up above a laundromat. Everything in it was free once.

NOEL FARRADAY (34) stands at the window with her coat still on, like she hasn't decided whether she's staying.

On the wall, a framed photograph of a harbour at night. It has been there longer than she has.

A radio murmurs somewhere down the hall – a song she half knows.

NOEL
(to herself)

Okay.

She doesn't move.

INT. NOEL'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

She sits at the little table by the kitchenette. Opens a beer. Doesn't drink it.

Her phone lights up. She turns it face down.

NOEL (CONT'D)
Not tonight.

She looks at the photograph again. The harbour. The lights.

INT. NOEL'S APARTMENT - LATER

The beer is still full. Noel is asleep in the chair, coat on.

The radio is still going. "Ordinary Weather" plays – the one her mother used to put on when the power went out.

She wakes. Listens. Turns it off.

EXT. THE VELVET ROOM - NIGHT

A club on a wet street. The sign buzzes. It has buzzed for forty years and nobody has ever fixed it.

Noel stands across the road, hands in pockets, looking up at it.

DESMOND (50s) comes out the side door with a bag of ice.

DESMOND
We're closed.

NOEL

I know.

DESMOND

Then what are you doing?

NOEL

Deciding.

He sets the ice down. Waits.

DESMOND

He played here, you know. Your father. Tuesdays, mostly. He was better on Tuesdays.

NOEL

Everyone's better on Tuesdays.

DESMOND

That's not true and you know it.

She almost smiles.

INT. THE VELVET ROOM - NIGHT

Chairs on tables. One light on over the piano.

Noel sits at it, doesn't play. Runs a thumb along the fallboard where somebody carved initials a long time ago.

DESMOND (O.S.)

You can touch it. It's a piano, not a shrine.

NOEL

Bit of both.

She plays four notes. Stops. Plays them again.

DESMOND

That's the one he'd start with.

NOEL

I know.

FADE OUT.